

ISSUE 55

AUGUST 25, 2026

LAST WEEK IN TÜRKİYE

A weekly roundup of the top news
and developments in Türkiye



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REMINDERS BY NUMBERS



524 DAYS

since Ekrem Imamoglu was arrested.
The indictment seeks up to 2,430 years
in prison



53 DAYS

since comedian Deniz Göktaş was
arrested. He remains in prison
awaiting trial over charges related to
his stand-up show.



41 DAYS

since Nasuh Mahruki, AKUT
rescue group founder, jailed in
pretrial detention on charges of
“inciting the public to hatred and
hostility on a post on X.



25 DAYS

since elected Üsküdar Mayor Sinem
Dedetaş was jailed pending trial,
despite not being convicted of any
crime.





AZİZ İHSAN AKTAŞ CASE: VERDICTS FOR MAYORS

Ahmet Özer and Abdurrahman Tutdere were acquitted of the cited bribery/document charges (Özer also received an 8-month suspended sentence), while Zeydan Karalar, Oya Tekin, Kadir Aydar, Utku Caner Çaykara, and Rıza Akpolat received prison sentences ranging from 5 years 10 months to nearly 23 years for various offenses including bribery.





WAVE OF MAYORS JOINS ÖZEL'S NEW PARTY

Two hundred and thirty-two mayors left the CHP to join the newly founded YENİ Party, led by Özgür Özel. This major political shift includes two metropolitan municipalities, 109 metropolitan districts and numerous local party organisations across Türkiye.





UK DUMPS PLASTIC WASTE IN TÜRKIYE

A Guardian investigation found irrigation canals polluted with high levels of microplastics in Türkiye's farmland, a major destination for UK plastic waste. The contamination was discovered in a waterway near a major recycling hub. Britain shipped 139,000 tonnes of plastic waste to Türkiye in 2025, while EU plastic waste exports to Türkiye rose 19% year-on-year to more than 500,000 tonnes.



YENİ PARTİ



KNIFE ATTACK ON YENİ PARTY GAZİANTEP MP MELİH MERİÇ

Yeni Party Gaziantep MP Melih Meriç was stabbed on August 18 while meeting residents in Şahinbey, and after surgery he was placed in intensive care in stable condition with no immediate life-threatening complications reported. Authorities said the suspect, identified as a former CHP Oğuzeli district chairman in Gaziantep.

Prosecutors launched an investigation and political leaders condemned the attack.





TWO MORE ŞAHİN-LINKED VEHICLES INVESTIGATED

Turkish authorities are investigating vehicles assigned to former Interior Minister İdris Naim Şahin after one allegedly transported two wanted men linked to the Süleymancılar, a religious community under criminal investigation. Justice Ministry sources allege that two additional vehicles were used outside their designated purpose and in “suspicious activities,” with the investigation continuing.





A 15-YEAR-OLD STUDENT INTERN DIED IN A WORKPLACE ACCIDENT

A 15-year-old student intern, Eren Gündoğdu, died after being electrocuted while pulling electrical cables at a construction site in Çerkezköy, Tekirdağ. He was taken to Çerkezköy State Hospital after suffering severe injuries but could not be saved, and gendarmerie authorities have launched an investigation into the incident.





MP VISITS VETERANS

Selçuk Türkoğlu, the İYİ Party MP for Bursa, has been discharged from the hospital after falling ill following police intervention while showing support for veterans at Ankara's Kurtuluş Park. Türkoğlu, who reportedly suffered a heart spasm, was taken to the Hacettepe Emergency Department for treatment after the incident.

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